

Challenge Write-Up Template

Instructions: Copy this template for every challenge you submit. Fill in every section — a write-up that only shows the final flag without explanation will not receive full credit. Delete these italicized instruction lines before submitting.

Challenge Information

Student Name	Facon, Janna Mae L.
Section / Class	BSIT- 3G
Challenge Name	Printer Shares
Category	General Skills
Points / Difficulty	Easy
Date Solved	8/13/2026
Flag Format Given	PicoCTF{...}

1. Challenge Description

Restate the challenge in your own words: what were you given, and what were you asked to find or do? Do not simply copypaste the original prompt.

The challenge involved retrieving an important file that was accidentally sent to a network printer. The task was to connect to the available network printer share, inspect its contents, find the flag.txt file, and retrieve it so that the flag could be read and submitted to the challenge.

2. Initial Analysis / Reconnaissance

What did you check first? What did file, strings, a webpage view-source, or another first look tell you? What category did you decide this was, and why?

The first step that I did was read the challenge description carefully to understand what I needed to find. From the description, I learned that an important file had accidentally been sent to a network printer and that I needed to retrieve it from the print server. Since this suggested that a network file-sharing service was being used, I decided to investigate the available SMB shares. The challenge was therefore mainly related to **SMB network shares and file retrieval**.

3. Tools and Commands Used

List every tool/command you used, in the order you used them, and what each one told you.

<i>Tool / Command</i>	<i>What it was used for</i>	<i>Result / Output</i>
<code>mkdir printer_shares</code>	Created a directory to work with the printer share	Created printer_shares
<code>smbclient -L //mysterious-sea.picoctf.net -N -p 50576</code>	Listed the available SMB shares on the remote server	Found the shares and IPC\$ shares
<code>smbclient //mysterious-sea.picoctf.net/shares -N -p 50576</code>	Connected to the shares SMB share anonymously	Successfully connected to the network share
<code>dir</code>	Listed the files available in the SMB share	Found dummy.txt and flag.txt
<code>get flag.txt</code>	Downloaded flag.txt from the remote share	Successfully retrieved the flag file
<code>exit</code>	Closed the SMB session	Returned to the normal terminal
<code>cat flag.txt</code>	Displayed the contents of the downloaded file	Revealed the correct PicoCTF flag

4. Solution Walkthrough

Explain your reasoning step by step — not just what you typed, but why you tried it and what you concluded from the result. Include screenshots, code snippets, or command output where useful. A reader who has not seen the challenge should be able to follow your logic and arrive at the same answer.

Step 1

The first step that I did was read the challenge description to understand the objective. I learned that someone had accidentally sent an important file to a network printer and that I needed to retrieve the file from the print server. This suggested that I should look for a network file-sharing service that could contain the misplaced file.

Easy

picoCTF 2026

INSTANCE 

Additional details appear once you launch your instance.

HINTS

- 2
-
- Reveal hint

The second step was to create a separate directory where I could work with the files from the printer share. I used `mkdir printer_shares` to create the directory. This gave me an organized location for storing the file that I would retrieve from the remote server.

[illegible]

The third step was to investigate the SMB shares available on the remote server. I used the `smbclient -L` command with the server address and port shown in the challenge environment. The command displayed the available shares, including a share named `shares` and an `IPC$` share. The `shares` share looked relevant because it appeared to be the location where the printer files could be stored.

```
Factor@kali:~$ smbclient //10.10.10.10/printer_shares -u '' -H 0x00000000 -c 'nc' -P 445
smb: > ls
ls
drwxr-xr-x  2 root root 4096 Feb  4 20:25 dummy.txt
-rw-r--r--  1 root root  1024 Feb  4 22:12 flag.txt
smb: > cat flag.txt
cat flag.txt
1337
smb: > exit
exit
Factor@kali:~$
```

Step 4

The fourth step was to connect to the shares SMB share. I used smbclient with the server address, the /shares path, the -N option for an anonymous connection, and the provided port. The connection was successful, and I was placed inside the SMB command prompt where I could inspect the contents of the remote share.

```
Factor@kali:~$ smbclient //10.10.10.10/printer_shares -u '' -H 0x00000000 -c 'nc' -P 445
smb: > ls
ls
drwxr-xr-x  2 root root 4096 Feb  4 20:25 dummy.txt
-rw-r--r--  1 root root  1024 Feb  4 22:12 flag.txt
smb: > cat flag.txt
cat flag.txt
1337
smb: > exit
exit
Factor@kali:~$
```

Step 5

The fifth step was to list the contents of the network share. I used the dir command inside the SMB prompt. The output showed two files, dummy.txt and flag.txt. Since the challenge was asking me to retrieve the important file, flag.txt was clearly the file I needed.

```

pico@kali:~/ctf$ smbclient //10.10.10.10/printer_shares -u user -H 1234567890 --no-pass
smbclient //10.10.10.10/printer_shares -u user -H 1234567890 --no-pass
smb: > ls
  dir             0      0 Fri Mar  4 20:25:46 2020
  dump.txt        0      0 Fri Mar  4 20:25:46 2020
  flag.txt        0      0 Fri Mar  4 20:25:46 2020
smb: > get flag.txt
getting file //10.10.10.10/flag.txt (10.1 KiB/1024 bytes) (average 10.1 KiB/second)
smb: > exit
pico@kali:~/ctf$ cat flag.txt
picoCTF{5mb_pr1nter_5h4re5_78a2840d}

```

Step 6

The sixth step was to download the flag file from the network share. I used the get flag.txt command inside the SMB prompt. The terminal confirmed that flag.txt was successfully downloaded from the remote server to my local working directory.

```

pico@kali:~/ctf$ smbclient //10.10.10.10/printer_shares -u user -H 1234567890 --no-pass
smbclient //10.10.10.10/printer_shares -u user -H 1234567890 --no-pass
smb: > ls
  dir             0      0 Fri Mar  4 20:25:46 2020
  dump.txt        0      0 Fri Mar  4 20:25:46 2020
  flag.txt        0      0 Fri Mar  4 20:25:46 2020
smb: > get flag.txt
getting file //10.10.10.10/flag.txt (10.1 KiB/1024 bytes) (average 10.1 KiB/second)
smb: > exit
pico@kali:~/ctf$ cat flag.txt
picoCTF{5mb_pr1nter_5h4re5_78a2840d}

```

Step 7

The seventh and final step was to exit the SMB session and return to the normal terminal. I then used cat flag.txt to display the contents of the downloaded file. The flag revealed was picoCTF{5mb_pr1nter_5h4re5_78a2840d}

FLAG 1

Correct flag!

5. Flag

`picoCTF{5mb_pr1nter_5h4re5_78a2840d}`

6. Key Concept / What I Learned

In 2-4 sentences, name the underlying security concept or vulnerability class this challenge taught (e.g. "weak RSA exponent," "reflected XSS," "stack buffer overflow"). This is the part of the write-up most worth remembering after the flag is submitted.

The main concept I learned from this challenge is **SMB network file sharing and anonymous access**. SMB can be used to share files across a network, and if a share allows anonymous access, users may be able to view or retrieve files without authentication. This challenge showed the importance of properly securing network shares and checking what files are accessible through them.

7. References

List any external resource you consulted beyond course materials (a tool's documentation, a technique explainer, a similar public write-up). It is normal and expected to use references — just cite them.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qTKdqTu7u_A
